

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 4
♥ A 2
♦ 10 6 4 3
♣ Q J 10 7 5

♠ K Q 8 6

♥ K 7 5 3

♦ A Q 5

♣ 8 4



♠ 5 2

♥ Q J 10

♦ J 9 8 2

♣ 9 6 3 2

♠ A J 10 7 3

♥ 9 8 6 4

♦ K 7

♣ A K

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	4 ♥
Pass	4 ♠	Pass	6 ♠
All Pass			

6 ♠ by South

he is now out of ♣s, just remember the bidding - he must have had 5 ♠s and 4 ♥s.

Suppose you play low on this ♥ (as South hopes you will). Dummy's ♥K will take the trick, and when another ♥ is played you will have to win it with your now bare ♥A. You will then have to play a ♦ or a ♣, giving South a ruff and sluff.

But if you take your ♥A now, then exit with your ♥2, South can win the ♥K but will still have to lose a ♥ to East.

[showcards W:CQ]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♣Q, East plays low and South wins the ♣A.

South pulls trumps in 2 rounds. He then takes the ♦K, ♦Q, ♦A, discarding a ♥ on the last one. Next he plays dummy's last ♣ to his ♣K.

Having done all this, South now plays a low ♥ from his hand. What do you play?

Play the ♥A.

If you followed what South was doing you will realize that he has eliminated both the ♦s and ♣s from both his hand and dummy. If it isn't clear that

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q J 9 5

♥ -

♦ 9 6 4 2

♣ 9 6 5 3

♠ 10 7 2

♥ J 8 7 3 2

♦ A K Q

♣ A K



♠ 8 4 3

♥ Q 10 4

♦ 8 7 3

♣ J 8 7 4

♠ A 6

♥ A K 9 6 5

♦ J 10 5

♣ Q 10 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♥
Pass	3 ♦	Pass	3NT
Pass	6 ♥		
All Pass			
6 ♥ by South			

[showcards N:HJ]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

West led the ♠K, won by South's ♠A. South played a small ♣ to dummy's ♣A, then led dummy's ♥J.

What do you play? ♥Q or ♥4?

Play the ♥4.

Remember that South opened 1 ♥, so he has 5 of them. With only 3 trumps out he has no intention of finessing. Perhaps he led the ♥J just to tempt you to cover in this situation.

If you play low he will win with one of his high ♥s and then you will have a sure ♥ winner. Along with the ♠ winner West has you will defeat the slam.

If you cover the ♥J with your ♥Q South will again win with one of his high ones. But now the position will be clear to South and he will return to dummy and play another ♥, finessing your ♥10. With no trump loser he will make the slam.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 9 5 2

♥ 7 2

♦ 8 6 4

♣ 10 8 5 3

♠ Q J 6

♥ 10 5 4

♦ A K 3

♣ A Q 7 4



♠ K 10 7 4

♥ A 3

♦ J 10 9 2

♣ K J 9

♠ 8 3

♥ K Q J 9 8 6

♦ Q 7 5

♣ 6 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

That winner will take care of whatever black-suit loser he may have.

If East has a ♣ trick it is important to get it established soon. So go up with the ♠A and play a ♣ through dummy's ♣ A Q. When South tries the ♠ suit again **EAST** can win and cash his ♣K for the setting trick.

If you play low on South's ♠ play East will be forced to win the trick and he cannot profitably attack the ♣ suit from his side.

[showcards W:H2 E:HA,H3,DJ S:S3,HK,H6,D6]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You decide a trump lead is called for and lead the ♥2. Your partner wins with the ♥A and plays the ♦J. South lets this go to dummy's ♦K, (but you know he has ♦Q), then plays a trump back to his ♥K, pulling the 2 outstanding trumps from West and East.

South's next play is the ♠3 from his hand. Do you play your ♠A or not?

Play the ♠A.

Even if South doesn't have the ♠K he can establish a ♠ winner just by leading twice toward the ♠ Q J.